

Pre-Workshop Setup Guide

Build Your First AI Agent Masterclass

Welcome! Please complete these setup steps **before** the workshop.

Option 1: Local Setup (Recommended)

Step 1: Install Python

You need **Python 3.12 or higher** (we recommend Python 3.13 or 3.14).

1. Go to: <https://www.python.org/downloads/>
2. Download **Python 3.14.2** (or 3.13.x) for your operating system
3. Run the installer
 - **Windows:** Check “Add Python to PATH” during installation
 - **Mac/Linux:** Follow the default installation steps

Verify your installation:

```
python --version
# Should show Python 3.12.x, 3.13.x, or 3.14.x
```

Step 2: Create an OpenAI Account & API Key

1. Go to: <https://platform.openai.com/signup>
2. Create an account (or sign in if you have one)
3. Navigate to API Keys: <https://platform.openai.com/settings/organization/api-keys>
4. Click “**Create new secret key**”
5. Copy and save your API key somewhere safe (you won’t be able to see it again)

Note: You may need to add credits to your account. New accounts typically get free trial credits, but you might need to add a payment method for \$5-10 of credits.

Step 3: Install Required Packages

Open a terminal/command prompt and run:

```
pip install openai langchain langchain-openai duckduckgo-search
```

Step 4: Set Your API Key

Option A - Environment Variable (Recommended)

Mac/Linux:

```
export OPENAI_API_KEY="your-api-key-here"
```

Windows (Command Prompt):

```
set OPENAI_API_KEY=your-api-key-here
```

Windows (PowerShell):

```
$env:OPENAI_API_KEY="your-api-key-here"
```

Option B - Create a .env file

Create a file named `.env` in your project folder:

```
OPENAI_API_KEY=your-api-key-here
```

Step 5: Verify Everything Works

Run this Python script to test your setup:

```
from openai import OpenAI

client = OpenAI()
response = client.chat.completions.create(
    model="gpt-4o-mini",
    messages=[{"role": "user", "content": "Say hello!"}]
)
print(response.choices[0].message.content)
```

If you see a greeting response, you're all set!

Option 2: Google Colab (No Installation Required)

If you have trouble with local setup, you can use Google Colab:

1. Go to: <https://colab.research.google.com>
2. Sign in with your Google account
3. You'll still need an OpenAI API key (see Step 2 above)
4. Install packages in Colab by running:

```
!pip install openai langchain langchain-openai duckduckgo-search
```

Pre-Workshop Checklist

Before the workshop, make sure you have:

- ☐ Python 3.12+ installed
 - ☐ OpenAI account created
 - ☐ OpenAI API key generated and saved
 - ☐ Required packages installed
 - ☐ Verified the test script works
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Need Help?

If you run into issues during setup, don't worry! We'll have time at the beginning of the workshop to troubleshoot. Just make sure you have:

- An OpenAI account with API access
- Either Python installed locally OR access to Google Colab

See you at the workshop!